Injury/Illness Reporting Policy

Policy Summary & Knowledge Check

Authority	Chief Operating Officer
Date Ratified	January 29, 2021
Next Review Date	February 2024
Previous Amendments	February 16, 2018; October 30, 2012
Related Document(s)	Appendix: Injury/Illness Reporting Form

Policy Summary

This policy outlines the procedure for reporting injuries and illnesses of any nature or severity — including fatalities, critical injuries, lost-time injuries, health care and first aid cases, property damage, near misses, fires, environmental releases, and occupational illness. It applies to all USC employees, volunteers, and visitors, and assigns responsibilities to workers, managers/supervisors, and first aid providers.

Key Takeaways

- Applies to all USC employees, volunteers, and visitors, and covers all injuries and illnesses regardless of nature or severity.
- "Injury" is defined as physical harm to an employee; "illness" is a deviation from the normal, healthy state of the body.
- Workers must report an injury or illness to a supervisor or manager immediately; if the worker is unable to report it themselves, whoever finds them must promptly report the situation to a supervisor.
- Upon notification, Managers/Supervisors must promptly ensure first aid is administered, ensure subsequent medical treatment is given and recorded if necessary, notify additional rescue or response teams as needed, and notify appropriate company personnel promptly.
- The First Aid provider must record the treatment and advice given in the First Aid Log and help ensure the injured or ill worker receives further medical attention as required.
- Reporting must be done immediately, verbally, and using the Injury/Illness Reporting Form, with the supervisor/manager (assisted by the worker) rating the incident, forming an action plan, implementing it, and notifying necessary parties through the Health & Safety Coordinator.

Knowledge Check

4 situational questions to check understanding of this policy. An answer key follows on the next page.

Q1. An employee suffers a minor cut requiring only a bandage. Does this need to be reported under the policy?

A. No, only lost-time injuries need to be reported.
B. Yes — the policy applies to all injuries and illnesses regardless of nature or severity, including first aid cases.
C. Only if it happened during a shift longer than 8 hours.
D. Only if a supervisor happens to see it occur.

Q2. A worker becomes unable to report their own injury due to its severity. What is required?

A. The First Aid provider must personally witness the injury occurring.
B. No report is made until the worker recovers enough to report it themselves.
C. Whomever happens upon the individual must promptly report the situation to a supervisor.
D. Only a manager who witnessed the incident directly can initiate the report.

Q3. After administering first aid, what must the First Aid provider do?

A. Report only to the Board of Directors.

B. Wait 24 hours before logging anything.

C. Nothing further is required.

D. Record the treatment and advice given in the First Aid Log.

Q4. How must an injury or illness initially be reported, per the Procedures section?

A. Immediately, verbally, and using the Injury/Illness Reporting Form.

B. Only through an anonymous hotline.

C. Only if a manager happens to be on-site at the time.

D. In writing only, within 48 hours.

Answer Key

Q1: B — Section 1.2 states this policy applies to all injuries and illnesses regardless of nature or severity, including first aid cases.

Q2: C — Section 3.1.2 states that if an employee is unable to report their own injury, whomever happens upon the individual must promptly report the situation to a supervisor.

Q3: D — Section 3.3.1 requires the First Aid provider to record given treatment and advice in the First Aid Log.

Q4: A — Section 4.1.1 states reporting must be done immediately, verbally, and using the Injury/Illness Reporting Form.